

Option 8A: Health, Human Rights and Intervention

Overview

Traditional definitions of development are based largely on economic measures but have been increasingly challenged by broader definitions based on environmental, social and political quality of life with many new measures used to record progress at all scales in human rights and human welfare. There are variations in the norms and laws of both national and global institutions that impact on decisions made at all scales, from local to global. These decisions lead to a wide range of geopolitical interventions via international and national policies, from development aid through to military campaigns.

The impact of geopolitical interventions on both human health and wellbeing and human rights is variable and contested, with some groups appearing to benefit disproportionately, which can lead to increasing inequalities and injustice.

Content

Enquiry question 1: What is human development and why do levels vary from place to place?	
Key idea	Detailed content
8A.1 Concepts of human development are complex and contested.	a. Human development has traditionally been measured using the growth of GDP as an end in itself but the relationship between human contentment and levels of wealth and income is complex (Happy Planet Index) and many dominant western models are contested (🌐 Sharia law or Bolivia under Evo Morales). (1)
	b. Improvements in environmental quality, health, life expectancy and human rights are seen by some (Rosling) as more significant goals for development while economic growth is often seen as the best means of delivering them.
	c. Education is central to economic development (human capital) and to the understanding and assertion of human rights. However, this view is not universally shared (attitudes to gender equality in education), so both access to education and standards of achievement vary greatly among countries (UNESCO).
8A.2 There are notable variations in human health and life expectancy.	a. There are considerable variations in health and life expectancy in the developing world that are explained by differential access to basic needs such as food, water supply and sanitation, and which impact particularly on levels of infant and maternal mortality. (2)
	b. Variations in health and life expectancy in the developed world are largely a function of differences in lifestyles, levels of deprivation and the availability, cost and effectiveness of medical care. (2)
	c. There are significant variations in health and life expectancy within countries (🌐 UK or Brazil) that can be related to ethnic variations, income levels and inequalities, which in turn impact on lifestyles (🌐 Indigenous peoples in Australia).

Enquiry question 1: What is human development and why do levels vary from place to place?

Key idea	Detailed content
8A.3 Governments and International Government Organisations play a significant role in defining development targets and policies.	a. The relationship between economic and social development is complex and dependent on decisions made by governments on the importance of social progress; this ranges from welfare states with high levels of social spending to totalitarian regimes run by elites with low levels of spending on health and education. (3)
	b. The dominant IGOs (World Bank, IMF, WTO) have traditionally promoted neo-liberal views of development based on the adoption of free trade, privatisation and deregulation of financial markets but also, recent programmes have been aimed at improving environmental quality, health, education and human rights.
	c. Progress against the United Nation's Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) has been mixed in terms of individual countries, global regions and targets; the UN post-2015 development agenda expands on the MDGs, setting new goals to include sustainable development.

Enquiry question 2: Why do human rights vary from place to place?

Key idea	Detailed content
8A.4 Human rights have become important aspects of both international law and international agreements.	a. The Universal Declaration of Human Rights (UDHR) is a statement of intent and a framework for foreign policy statements to explain economic or military intervention but not all states have signed the Declaration.
	b. The European Convention on Human Rights (ECHR) was drafted by the nations of the Council of Europe to help prevent conflict and integrated into the UK by the Human Rights Act of 1998; the ECHR remains controversial as some see it as an erosion of national sovereignty.
	c. The Geneva Convention forms a basis in international law for prosecuting individuals and organisations who commit war crimes and is endorsed by 196 countries; however few cases come to trial and over 150 countries continue to engage in torture.
8A.5 There are significant differences between countries in both their definitions and protection of human rights.	a. Some states (🌐) frequently invoke human rights in international forums and debates whilst others prioritise economic development over human rights and defend this approach (🌐).
	b. Some superpowers and emerging powers have transitioned to more democratic governments but the degree of democratic freedom varies (🌐 comparison of an authoritarian and a democratic system); the protection of human rights and degree of freedom of speech varies.
	c. Levels of political corruption vary and can be measured (Index of Corruption); high levels of corruption are a threat to human rights as the rule of law can be subverted. (4)
8A.6 There are significant variations in human rights within countries, which are reflected in different levels of social development.	a. In some states (post-colonial states) there are significant groups, defined by gender and/or ethnicity that have had fewer rights than the dominant group.
	b. Differences in rights are frequently reflected in differences in levels of health and education (🌐 First Nations in Canada).
	c. A demand for equality from both women and ethnic groups has been an important part of the history of many states in recent years (🌐 Afghanistan, Australia, Bolivia) with progress taking place at different rates.

Enquiry question 3: How are human rights used as arguments for political and military intervention?

Key idea	Detailed content
8A.7 There are different forms of geopolitical intervention in defence of human rights.	a. There is a wide range of geopolitical interventions to address development and human rights issues: development aid, trade embargoes, military aid, indirect and direct military action.
	b. Interventions are promoted by IGOs, national governments and NGOs (Amnesty International, Human Rights Watch) but there is seldom consensus about the validity of these interventions.
	c. Some Western governments frequently condemn human rights violations and use them as conditions for offering aid, negotiating trade agreements, and as a reason for military intervention, which challenge ideas of national sovereignty (🌐).
8A.8 Some development is focused on improving both human rights and human welfare but other development has very negative environmental and cultural impacts.	a. Development aid takes many forms from charitable gifts to address the impacts of hazards (🌐 Haiti) administered both by NGOs (🌐 Oxfam or Christian Aid) and national governments, to IGOs offering loans. (5)
	b. The impact of development aid is contested, successes include progress in dealing with life-threatening conditions (malaria) and improvements in some aspects of human rights (gender equality) but critics suggest that it encourages dependency, and promotes corruption and the role of the elite at the expense of human rights and minority groups. (6)
	c. Some economic development, both by superpowers and TNCs, has very serious impacts on the environment in which minority groups live and disregards their human rights to their land and culture (🌐 oil in the Niger Delta or Dakota and Keystone XL pipeline, and land acquisitions by TNCs in Ethiopia). (7)
8A.9 Military aid and both direct and indirect military intervention are frequently justified in terms of human rights.	a. Global strategic interests might drive military interventions but are often justified by the protagonists in terms of human rights (🌐).
	b. Military aid, both in terms of training personnel and weapons sales, is sometimes used to support countries that themselves have questionable human rights records (🌐).
	c. Direct military intervention is part of a 'war on terror', which is partially justified as promoting human rights (🌐) but is compromised by the use of torture by combatant states that have signed the Declaration of Human Rights (🌐).

Enquiry question 4: What are the outcomes of geopolitical interventions in terms of human development and human rights?

Key idea	Detailed content
8A.10 There are several ways of measuring the success of geopolitical interventions.	a. Measurements of success comprise a wide range of variables, including improvements in health, life expectancy, educational levels, gender equality, freedom of speech and successful management of refugees as well as increases in GDP per capita. (8) b. For some governments and IGOs, the introduction of democratic institutions is deemed important and freedom of expression is seen as central to the development of democratic and capitalist societies. c. For other countries, (🌐) success is measured in terms of economic growth with less attention to holistic development (human wellbeing) or human rights and the development of democratic institutions.
8A.11 Development aid has a mixed record of success.	a. The relationship of aid, development, health and human rights is unclear, with relative success stories in some states (🌐 Botswana or Ebola in West Africa) contrasted with relative failure in other states (🌐 Haiti, Iraq). b. In some states that receive substantial development aid, economic inequalities have increased while in other states economic inequalities have decreased; this in turn impacts on human development including health and life expectancy. (9) c. The extent to which superpowers use development aid as an extension of their foreign policies and judge success in terms of access to resources, political support in IGOs and formation of military alliances. (10)
8A.12 Military interventions, both direct and indirect, have a mixed record of success.	a. The recent history of military interventions, both direct and indirect, suggest that there are significant costs, including loss of sovereignty and human rights (🌐) and contrasts between short-term gains with long-term costs (🌐). b. Other non-military interventions may have a stronger record of improving both human rights and development (🌐 UN Women or UNICEF). c. Lack of action also has global consequences (🌐) which may impact negatively on progress in environmental, political and social development (human wellbeing and human rights).

Guidance for integrating geographical skills for Topic 8 Option 8A

Students must use both quantitative and qualitative skills in this topic. The following guidance on integrating geographical skills gives suggestions for opportunities to meet these requirements.

These skills are **not** exclusive to the topic areas under which they appear; students will need to be able to apply these skills across any suitable topic area throughout their course of study. *Appendix 1* outlines the full range of geographical skills.

- (1) Comparison of different measurements of development using ranked data.
- (2) Use of scatter graphs and correlation techniques to describe the relationship between health and life expectancy and other indicators of development.
- (3) Use of proportional circles to show the relative size of government spending and the share of that spending devoted to welfare, health and education across developing, emerging and developed nations.
- (4) Use qualitative and quantitative indicators to derive an index of corruption and show this on global maps to compare variations in levels of corruption with types of government.
- (5) Use of flow-lines on global maps to show both the direction and level of aid from donor to recipient global regions.
- (6) Evaluating source material, including newspaper articles and marketing material to determine the impact of development aid.
- (7) Interpreting images to evaluate the impact of economic development on the environment minority groups live in.
- (8) Critical analysis of source material to identify possible reasons for error in the assessment of success for interventions in the management of refugees.
- (9) Using Gini Coefficient and income or wealth proportion for quintiles or deciles of the population to describe inequalities in and between nations.
- (10) Critical analysis of source materials to identify possible misuse of data in the qualitative assessment of success for military interventions such as Iraq, Afghanistan and Libya.

Topic 8: Global Development and Connections

Option 8B: Migration, Identity and Sovereignty

Overview

Globalisation involves movements of capital, goods and people. Tensions can result between the logic of globalisation, with its growing levels of environmental, social and economic interdependence among people, economies and nation states and the traditional definitions of national sovereignty and territorial integrity. International migration not only changes the ethnic composition of populations but also changes attitudes to national identity. At the same time, nationalist movements have grown in some places challenging dominant models of economic change and redefining ideas of national identity.

Global governance has developed to manage a number of common global issues (environmental, social, political and economic) and has a mixed record in its success in dealing with them. It has promoted growth and political stability for some people in some places whilst not benefiting others. Unequal power relations have tended to lead to unequal environmental, social and economic outcomes.

Content

Enquiry question 1: What are the impacts of globalisation on international migration?	
Key idea	Detailed content
8B.1 Globalisation has led to an increase in migration both within countries and among them.	a. Globalisation has caused extremely significant changes in the global economic system, changing the pattern of demand for labour; this has encouraged both rural-urban migration within countries (🌏 China) and international migration between countries (🌐 EU-Schengen).
	b. Between 3–4% of the global population live outside their country of birth but this proportion varies greatly between countries because of different policies relating to international migration and levels of engagement with the global economy (🌏 Singapore or Japan or Australia).
	c. The pattern of international migration is changing and will continue to change because environmental, economic and political events affect both the source areas of many migrants and their destinations; this results in flows of economic migrants, refugees and asylum seekers. (1)

Enquiry question 1: What are the impacts of globalisation on international migration?

Key idea	Detailed content
8B.2 The causes of migration are varied, complex and subject to change.	a. Most migrants move for work or to re-join family members; there are other significant causes, including displacement of refugees due to conflict and poverty in their regions of origin (🌐 migrants crossing the Mediterranean). (2)
	b. Economic theory suggests that economic efficiency is maximised when goods (free trade), capital (deregulated financial markets) and labour (open-borders) can move freely across international borders but this poses serious challenges for national identity and sovereignty.
	c. The movement of labour is unrestricted within many nation states to ensure efficient allocation of resources (🌐 regional movements in the UK) and the same logic applies for some global regions (EU) but does not yet apply at a global level.
8B.3 The consequences of international migration are varied and disputed.	a. Migration changes the cultural and ethnic composition of nation states but the integration of migrants varies both between nations and within them.
	b. Migration causes political tensions because of differences in perceptions of the social, economic, cultural and demographic impacts (🌐 Labour flows across the Mexico-US border and between EU states). (3)
	c. There are variations in the ability of people to migrate across national borders according to levels of skill and income; and opportunities, including the presence or absence of controls and international borders.

Enquiry question 2: How are nation states defined and how have they evolved in a globalising world?

Key idea	Detailed content
8B.4 Nation states are highly varied and have very different histories.	a. National sovereign states vary greatly in their ethnic, cultural and linguistic unity (🌐 Iceland compared to Singapore); this results from their history of population growth, their degree of isolation and the role of migration. (4)
	b. Many national borders are a consequence of physical geography and historical development; other borders are a result of colonial history and might not take account of different ethnic or religious groups (🌐 Iraq or Rwanda), which can lead to problems of sovereignty and legitimacy.
	c. There are many contested borders (🌐 Ukraine/Russia) and not all nation states are universally recognised as such (🌐 Taiwan) which can lead to both potential conflict and population movements.
8B.5 Nationalism has played a role in the development of the modern world.	a. 19th-century nationalism was important in the development of empires and a source of conflict in Europe and beyond as other nations became part of larger empires (🌐 British Raj in India).
	b. Since 1945, many new nation states have emerged as European empires disintegrated (🌐 1960s 'wind of change' in Africa); the transition to independence frequently involved conflicts that were costly environmentally, economically and in human terms (🌐 Viet-Nam or Sudan).
	c. Patterns of migration between former colonies and the imperial core country are still evident and important in changing the ethnic composition and cultural heterogeneity of those countries. (5)
8B.6 Globalisation has led to the deregulation of capital markets and the emergence of new state forms.	a. Globalisation has encouraged the growth of states that have low-tax regimes which provide havens for the profits for TNCs and homes for wealthy expatriates.
	b. Most governments and IGOs have accepted the emergence of tax-havens although many NGOs have raised objections.
	c. Growing global inequalities have been recognised as a major threat to the sustainability of the global economic system and some governments have promoted alternative models (🌐 Bolivia or Ecuador). (6)

Enquiry question 3: What are the impacts of global organisations on managing global issues and conflicts?

Key idea	Detailed content
8B.7 Global organisations are not new but have been important in the post-1945 world.	a. The United Nations was the first post-war IGO to be established and has grown in importance; its role in global governance is affected by the different geopolitical visions of members of the Security Council and its multiple functions in managing global environmental, socio-economic and political problems.
	b. Interventions by the UN through the use of economic sanctions and direct military intervention have been made in defence of human rights but have a mixed record of success. (🌐 Trade Embargo Iran or UN forces in Congo).
	c. Some member states (US, UK) have operated independently of the UN in intervening in countries labelled as 'fragile states' or to conduct a 'war on terror' with profound impacts on geopolitical relations and global stability.
8B.8 IGOs established after the Second World War have controlled the rules of world trade and financial flows.	a. The IMF, WB and WTO were established by the WWII allied nations and have been important in maintaining the dominance of 'western' capitalism, global economic management and trade policy (free trade).
	b. Global borrowing rules and trade policies have been especially effective in delivering growth to the developed world, but the impact of Structural Adjustment and HIPC policies on the developing world's economies and economic sovereignty is disputed (🌐 Jamaica's structural adjustment programme).
	c. Membership of global trade and financial IGOs is almost universal, as a result of the dominance of these organisations, but regional groupings have emerged in the form of trading blocs (🌐 NAFTA/SEATO) and in some cases (EU) there has been a movement to closer political unity.
8B.9 IGOs have been formed to manage the environmental problems facing the world, with varying success.	a. Global environmental issues including issues concerning the quality of the atmosphere and biosphere (🌐 Montreal Protocol on Substances that Deplete the Ozone Layer) and biosphere (🌐 Convention on International Trade in Endangered Species of Wild Fauna and Flora CITES). (7)
	b. IGOs have been involved in developing laws for managing oceans (🌐 UN Convention on the Law of the Sea) and international rivers (🌐 Helsinki Water Convention rules) as well as monitoring the state of the environment (🌐 Millennium Ecosystem Assessment).
	c. IGO management also includes responsibility for Antarctica as a continent of peace and science (🌐 Antarctic Treaty System).

Enquiry question 4: What are the threats to national sovereignty in a more globalised world?

Key idea	Detailed content
8B.10 National identity is an elusive and contested concept.	a. Nationalism remains a powerful force; it is reinforced through education, sport and by political parties stressing loyalty to both the institutions and the ideals of nation states. b. Identity and loyalty has historically been tied to distinctive legal systems, methods of governance, national 'character' or even a landscape (🌍 The English Countryside). c. Most countries are multi-national with many contrasting ethnic groups; questions of national identity and loyalties are therefore complex, especially in an era of globalisation.
8B.11 There are challenges to national identity.	a. Many UK-based companies are foreign owned (🌍 EDF or Jaguar Land Rover (JLR)), making 'Made in Britain' an increasingly complex idea. (8) b. 'Westernisation' is often dominated by US cultural values through the operation of large corporations in both retailing and entertainment; this, in turn, promotes a distinctive view of the benefits the dominant capitalist model. c. Ownership of property, land and businesses in countries is increasingly non-national (🌍 Qatari and Russian property in London and US or Indian or Chinese ownership of TNCs), which impacts on national identity. (9)
8B.12 There are consequences of disunity within nations.	a. There are strong nationalist movements seeking to create independent, smaller states whilst remaining within larger trading groups (🌍 Catalonia or Scotland in the EU). b. There are significant political tensions in the BRIC and other emerging nations resulting from the uneven pattern of the costs and benefits of globalisation. c. The role of the state is variable and national identity is not always strong, especially in 'fragile states' where there are stark differences between the politically and economically powerful elite, foreign investment groups and the wider population (🌍 Somalia). (10)

Guidance for integrating geographical skills for Topic 8 Option 8B

Students must use both quantitative and qualitative skills in this topic. The following guidance on integrating geographical skills gives suggestions for opportunities to meet these requirements.

These skills are **not** exclusive to the topic areas under which they appear; students will need to be able to apply these skills across any suitable topic area throughout their course of study. *Appendix 1* outlines the full range of geographical skills.

- (1) Use of flow-lines on global maps showing flows, both the direction and number of migrants among global regions.
- (2) Interpreting oral accounts from migrants to investigate the cause of migration.
- (3) Interpreting a range of opinions on the contribution of migrants to the culture and social life of two contrasting nations.
- (4) Use of divided bar graphs to compare the ethnic diversity of countries.
- (5) Comparison of global maps of languages and colonial histories to analyse relationship between them (Anglophone, Francophone and Lusophone).
- (6) Using the Gini coefficient and income/wealth proportions for deciles of the population to describe inequalities within and between nation states.
- (7) Evaluating source material, including newspaper articles, to determine the impact of IGOs managing global environmental issues.
- (8) Use of proportional circles to show size of output and level of foreign ownership of different economic sectors.
- (9) Critical analysis of a variety of source material to identify possible reasons for errors in the assessment of the costs and benefits of foreign ownership (property land and businesses).
- (10) Critical analysis of source material to identify possible misuse of data in the assessment of role of the state and the success in promoting national identity.

Fieldwork

Overview

Students are required to complete a minimum of **four** days of fieldwork.

This fieldwork must relate to processes in **both** physical and human geography. It must also provide an introduction to the nature and process of a high-quality geographical enquiry.

Full details of the required fieldwork skills are provided in *Appendix 2: Fieldwork skills*.

Fieldwork statement

Centres will be required to provide evidence of this fieldwork (which can include days undertaken as part of a separate AS Level in Geography) in the form of a written fieldwork statement. See *Appendix 8: Fieldwork statement*.

Pearson will publish the final deadline date for submission of this form on our website each year. Failure to return the fieldwork statement on time will constitute malpractice on the part of the centre.

Relationship between the fieldwork and the independent investigation

The fieldwork will enable students to develop skills that they can use in their independent investigation.

Students may, but are not required, to use data collected in their four days' fieldwork as part of their independent investigation. However, it is also possible to carry out the independent investigation on a separate topic with new data collected.

Non-examination assessment: Independent Investigation

Overview

The purpose of this non-examination assessment is to test students' skills in independent investigation. Students are required to undertake an independent investigation that involves (but which need not be restricted to) fieldwork. The focus of the investigation must be derived from the specification the student is studying. The guidance for word length is 3000-4000 words.

The student defines a question or issue relating to the compulsory or optional content. The student's investigation will incorporate fieldwork data (collected individually or as part of a group) and own research and/or secondary data. The student's report will evidence independent analysis and evaluation of data, presentation of data findings and extended writing.

Content

The independent investigation may relate to human or physical geography or it may integrate them.

The independent investigation must:

- be based on a question or issue defined and developed by the student individually to address aims, questions and/or hypotheses relating to any of the compulsory or optional content
- incorporate field data and/or evidence from field investigations, collected individually or in groups
- draw on the student's own research, including their own field data and, if relevant, secondary data sourced by the student
- require the student independently to contextualise, analyse and summarise findings and data
- involve the individual drawing of conclusions and their communication by means of extended writing and the presentation of relevant data.

The table below shows a suitable A Level Geography route to enquiry that forms the student's independent investigation.

Stage	Description
Purpose, identification of a suitable question/aim/hypothesis and developing a focus	Identify appropriate field research questions/aims/hypotheses, based on their knowledge and understanding of relevant aspects of physical and/or human geography. Research the relevant literature sources linked to possible fieldwork opportunities presented by the environment, considering their practicality and relationship to compulsory and optional content. Understand the nature of the current literature research relevant to the focus. This should be clearly and appropriately referenced within the written report.
Designing the fieldwork methodologies, research and selection of appropriate equipment	Consideration of how to observe and record phenomena in the field and to design appropriate data-collection strategies taking account of sampling and the frequency and timing of observation. Demonstrate knowledge and understanding of how to select practical field methodologies (primary) appropriate to their investigation (may include a combination of qualitative and quantitative techniques).
Information collation and data representation and analysis	Know how to use an appropriate diagrams, graphs and maps, and using geospatial technologies to select and present relevant aspects of the investigation outcomes.
Analysis and explanation of information	Use techniques appropriate for analysing field data and research information. Demonstrate the ability to write a coherent analysis of fieldwork findings and results linked to a specific geographical focus.
Conclusions and critical reflection on methods and results	Use knowledge and understanding to interrogate and interpret meaning from their investigation (theory, concepts, comparisons), through the significance of conclusions. Demonstrate the ability to interrogate and critically examine field data (including any measurement errors) in order to comment on its accuracy and/or the extent to which it is representative and reliable.
Recognising the wider geographical context	Explain how the results relate to the wider geographical context and use the experience to extend geographical understanding. Show an understanding of the ethical dimensions of field research.

Learning hours for the independent investigation are not specified because the process of producing the report is iterative and undertaken independently.

The independent investigation report may be completed at school/college, or at home (or other location outside school/college), or at a combination of both.

Independent Investigation controls relating to student independence and teacher guidance to students

The rationale for the following rules is given in *Appendix 13*.

Guidance permitted at different stages:

- Investigation title stage (guidance and approval)
- Planning and investigation stage (guidance and approval)

Teachers:

Can:

- provide broad parameters for candidates' investigation proposals (including themes from the specification, locations, availability of equipment, time constraints);
- explain what independence means (see table in Appendix 6).
- advise on health and safety considerations, the use of equipment and potential ethical concerns.
- discuss with candidates their initial exploratory planning and tentative investigation titles.

Must:

- confirm that the provisional title has the potential to meet the assessment criteria and offer general guidance on any necessary amendments.
- review each candidate's Geography Independent Investigation Form. Within this review teachers should ensure that the proposed investigation can suitably access the specification requirements and give general guidance on the methodology and analytical tools that the candidate plans to use.
- promote good practice such as referencing and using a bibliography system.
- store work securely once it is handed in for formal assessment.

Must not²:

- provide candidates with a choice of titles or tasks from which candidates then choose.
- give detailed feedback to individual candidates about how to improve work to meet the assessment criteria. The guidance provided prior to final submission should only enable candidates to take the initiative in making amendments, rather than detailing what amendments should be made. This means that teachers must not provide templates and model answers for the work of specific candidates.
- mark work provisionally and share that mark so that the candidate may then improve it.
- return work to candidates after it has been submitted and marked.
- give guidance on how to make improvements to the draft in order to meet the assessment criteria so that candidates are no longer engaged in independent learning.

² This section applies also to third party fieldwork providers. Teachers must ensure that at all times they remain confident in the authenticity and independence of the candidate's work.

If teachers give any assistance which goes beyond general advice, for example³:

- provide detailed specific guidance on how to improve drafts to meet the assessment criteria;
- give detailed specific guidance on errors and omissions which limits candidates' opportunities to show initiative themselves;
- intervene personally to improve the presentation or content of work;
- provide primary or secondary data not collected by the candidate either individually or as part of a group

then they must record this assistance and take it into account when marking the work.

Annotation should be used to explain how marks were applied in the context of the additional assistance given.

If teachers and/or third party fieldwork providers give specific guidance which goes beyond general guidance and do not take it into account when marking the work, or record it, this will be considered as malpractice. If malpractice is suspected, the Awarding Organisation will investigate. If malpractice is found to have taken place a penalty will be applied dependent on the circumstances and severity of the malpractice.

For full information regarding malpractice please see the JCQ document 'Suspected Malpractice in Examinations and Assessments'.

Examples of specific guidance and general guidance are given in *Appendix 14*, page 117. These examples are not exhaustive.

Description of the level of independence at each stage of the investigation

Appendix 6 gives descriptions which, although they do not infer anything in the way of marks allocated for each stage of the investigation, are to specify the level of independence required at different stages.

Note that the level of independence at each stage is the minimum required (i.e. where collaboration is allowed it is not mandatory and candidates may work alone).

Levels of independence:

- Collaboration allowed - candidates may work as a class/group/pair,
- Independent work – candidates must work alone

If candidates collaborate (where independence is expected) and/or are given assistance beyond the parameters indicated in the table below, then the teacher must record this on the Geography Independent Investigation Form and take it into account when marking the work. Failure to do so will be considered as malpractice. If malpractice is suspected the Awarding Organisation will investigate. If malpractice is found to have taken place a penalty will be given dependent on the circumstances and severity of the malpractice.

For full information regarding malpractice please see the JCQ document 'Suspected Malpractice in Examinations and Assessments'.

Health and safety

All centres must comply with the new requirements (2011) of relevant legislation and codes of practice, including the Department for Education health and safety guidance for schools (www.education.gov.uk/schools/adminandfinance/healthandsafety) and the Health and Safety Executive – School trips and outdoor learning activities (www.hse.gov.uk/services/education/school-trips.pdf).

³ First three bullet points as per the JCQ *Instructions for conducting non-examination assessment*, section 4.2.

Centres should also develop their own mechanisms so that students know the importance of ensuring their own safety and that of others. This could include developing risk assessments as part of the preparation for fieldwork, for example by using Google Maps and Google StreetView to assess likely hazards and risk. Students who might be lone working should be provided with additional information and guidance and the centre must have suitable policies and procedures for lone working.

Resources

Students must have equal access to IT resources. Students should have access to a range of resources, literature and texts to enable them to make choices as required for their research task.

Storing students' work

Where students are completing the assignment over a number of sessions, at the end of each session their work must be saved and kept securely.

Word count

It is recommended that students write between 3000 and 4000 words for their independent investigation. Students will not be specifically penalised on the basis of the length of their written report. However, excessively high or low word counts may restrict students' ability to evidence the skills outlined in the marking criteria. Students must sign the candidate declaration in both the Geography independent investigation form (*Appendix 5*) and Mark sheet (*Appendix 7*).

Submission of the independent investigation report

The student's completed individual investigation report should be submitted to Pearson. The original Non-examination assessment Authentication Sheet must be included.

Independent Investigation plan guidance service

Pearson provides a free student planning guidance service. Please see our website for further details.

Assessment, internal standardisation and moderation

Candidates' investigations must be internally-assessed by centres, annotated to indicate how and why marks have been awarded, and internally-standardised, following the procedures specified in section 6.1 and 6.2 of the JCQ Instructions for conducting non-exam assessments. The independent investigation is then externally moderated. There is a maximum of 70 marks available for the independent investigation. Teachers should mark the independent investigation using the assessment criteria on the following pages. Teachers may annotate students' work but should also include any comments on the *Geography independent investigation form* (see Appendix 5) to justify the marks awarded.

Where marking has been carried out by more than one teacher in a centre, there must be a process of internal standardisation carried out to ensure that there is a consistent application of the assessment criteria.

Marks awarded by the centre will be subject to external moderation by Pearson. Moderation will ensure consistency with national standards and will include a review of assignments to ensure that the assignment-setting rules have been correctly applied by centres. Pearson will notify centres of the students whose work has been selected for moderation. This sample will take cohort size into account.

If the moderation indicates that centre assessment does not reflect national standards, an adjustment will be made to students' final marks to compensate.

For further information please refer to the Joint Council for Qualifications (JCQ) *Instructions for Conducting Non-examined Assessments* on the JCQ website: www.jcq.org.uk. The assessment of this qualification must comply with these instructions.

Non-examination assessment: assessment criteria

Teachers must mark students' work using the following assessment criteria.

Marking guidance

- All students must receive the same treatment. Teachers must mark the last student in exactly the same way as they mark the first.
- The assessment criteria descriptors should be used to assess which mark range students work best fits. When this has been determined, a decision must be taken on whether the work is placed at the 'bottom', 'middle' or 'top' of this mark range. A mark can then be confidently awarded.
- Mark schemes should be applied positively. Students must be rewarded for what they have shown they can do rather than be penalised for omissions.
- All the marks on the mark scheme are designed to be awarded. Teachers should always award full marks if deserved, i.e. if the answer matches the mark scheme. Teachers should be prepared to award zero marks if the student's response is not worthy of credit according to the mark scheme.
- Centres must internally moderate and cross-standardise work to ensure fairness, accuracy and reliability.

		Purpose of the Independent Investigation (12 marks) (AO1: 4 marks, AO2: 4 marks and AO 3: 4 marks)
Level	Mark	Descriptor
	0	No rewardable material.
Level 1	1–4	• Demonstrates isolated elements of geographical knowledge and understanding of location, geographical theory and comparative context, which are frequently irrelevant or inaccurate. (AO1) • May attempt to apply understanding to find links between the investigation's context and a broader geographical context but links are irrelevant with frequent inaccuracies. (AO2) • May attempt to investigate frequently irrelevant and narrow range of geographical sources in order to identify/obtain geographical information and data that is frequently inaccurate and only occasionally supports the investigation; the aim, question or hypothesis is generic or unlinked to research information, and provides an unfocused framework for investigation, with flawed consideration of manageability and/or scale; planned enquiry process is limited in clarity and structure. (AO3)
Level 2	5–8	• Demonstrates geographical knowledge and understanding of location, geographical theory and comparative context which is relevant but narrow or incomplete, and may include some inaccuracies. (AO1) • Applies understanding to find links between the investigation's context and a broader geographical context; links are mainly relevant and coherent but may include some inaccuracies. (AO2) • Investigates a range of mainly relevant geographical sources in order to identify/obtain mainly accurate geographical information and data that supports most parts of the investigation; research information is used to construct a generally valid aim, question or hypothesis that provides a mostly appropriate framework for investigation with some consideration of manageability and/or scale; planned enquiry process is adequately structured and clear. (AO3)
Level 3	9–12	• Demonstrates accurate and relevant geographical knowledge and understanding of location, geographical theory and comparative context throughout. (AO1) • Applies understanding to find coherent and relevant links between the investigation's context and a broader geographical context. (AO2) • Investigates a wide range of relevant geographical sources in order to identify/obtain accurate geographical information and data that support the investigation; research information is used to construct a justified aim, question or hypothesis that provides an appropriate framework for investigation at a manageable scale; planned enquiry process is logically structured and comprehensive. (AO3)

		Field Methodologies and Data Collection (10 marks) (AO3: 10 marks)
Level	Mark	Descriptor
	0	No rewardable material.
Level 1	1–3	• An inappropriate balance between range and depth of methods chosen to collect data and information relevant to the geographical focus. (AO3) • A sampling framework is absent or is not relevant to the topic being investigated. (AO3) • No consideration of either frequency or timing of observations. (AO3) • Research planning shows limited understanding of the ethical dimensions of field research methods. (AO3) • Poor quality data and information as a result of inaccurate use of methods with low levels of accuracy/precision. (AO3)
Level 2	4–7	• Chooses methods to collect data and information relevant to the geographical topic. (AO3) • A sampling framework is considered but may not be technically valid or successfully implemented. (AO3) • Consideration of either frequency or timing of observations. (AO3) • Research planning shows understanding of the ethical dimensions of field research methods, which may be generic or incomplete. (AO3) • Data and information collected using methods with inconsistent accuracy/precision. (AO3)
Level 3	8–10	• Chooses appropriate methods to collect a range of data and information relevant to the geographical topic. (AO3) • Designs a valid sampling framework explicitly linked and appropriate to the geographical focus being investigated. (AO3) • Considers both frequency and timing of observations. (AO3) • Research planning shows appropriate and relevant understanding of the ethical dimensions of field research methods. (AO3) • Obtains reliable data and information as a result of consistent use of methods with high levels of accuracy/precision. (AO3)

		Data Representation, Analysis, Interpretation and Evaluation of Techniques and Methodologies used (24 marks) (AO3: 24 marks)
Level	Mark	Descriptor
	0	No rewardable material.
Level 1	1–6	• Indiscriminate use of geographical skills to deconstruct data; connections used to show the statistical/ geographical significance of data are unsupported or linked to flawed evidence. (AO3) • Provides a flawed or incomplete appraisal of techniques and methodologies used including: - o ethical dimensions of field research - o utility and validity of chosen methodologies. (AO3) • Any attempt to synthesise research findings is incoherent; conclusions may be attempted but are frequently flawed and unsupported or linked to irrelevant evidence. (AO3) • Conclusions, if attempted, are simplistic and generic; may attempt to support conclusions with frequently irrelevant references to fieldwork data or information; responses are presented in a manner that is unclear and/or technically inaccurate. (AO3)
Level 2	7–12	• Uses geographical skills, which may not be the most appropriate, to deconstruct data in order to show connections that lack support from evidence and the statistical/ geographical significance of data, which may be incomplete and lack accuracy. (AO3) • Provides a narrow or imbalanced appraisal of techniques and methodologies used including: - o ethical dimensions of field research - o utility and validity of chosen methodologies. (AO3) • Synthesises research findings in a superficial manner to form some rational conclusions that are occasionally supported by evidence which might be limited or incomplete. (AO3) • Communicates conclusions that are supported by fieldwork data or information which are occasionally relevant; responses are presented in a manner which may be occasionally incoherent and is sometimes technically accurate. (AO3)

		Data Representation, Analysis, Interpretation and Evaluation of Techniques and Methodologies used <i>continued</i>
Level	Mark	Descriptor
Level 3	13–18	• Uses appropriate geographical skills to deconstruct data in order to show partially evidenced connections and mostly accurate statistical/geographical significance of data. (AO3) • Provides a generally balanced appraisal, that may lack detail in some aspects of techniques and methodologies used including: - o ethical dimensions of field research - o utility and validity of chosen methodologies. (AO3) • Synthesises research findings coherently to form rational conclusions that are mostly supported by evidence. (AO3) • Communicates conclusions that are supported by mostly relevant fieldwork data or information presented in a manner which is appropriate and mostly technically accurate. (AO3)
Level 4	19–24	• Uses appropriate geographical skills to deconstruct data in order to show evidenced connections and accurate statistical/geographical significance of data. (AO3) • Provides detailed and balanced appraisal of techniques and methodologies used including: - o ethical dimensions of field research - o utility and validity of chosen methodologies. (AO3) • Synthesises research findings coherently to form rational evidence-based conclusions. (AO3) • Communicates convincing conclusions that are supported by the clear and technically accurate presentation of relevant fieldwork data or information. (AO3)

		Conclusions and Critical Evaluation of the Overall Investigation (24 marks) (AO1: 4 marks, AO2: 4 marks and AO3: 16 marks)
Level	Mark	Descriptor
	0	No rewardable material.
Level 1	1–6	• Demonstrates isolated elements of geographical knowledge and understanding of location, geographical theory and comparative context, which are frequently irrelevant or inaccurate. (AO1) • May attempt to apply understanding to find links between the investigation's conclusions and a broader geographical context, but these may be inaccurate or irrelevant. (AO2). • Synthesis of research findings is indiscriminate and only occasionally coherent. (AO3) • Appraisal of the reliability of evidence and validity of conclusions is imbalanced and frequently narrow or flawed. (AO3) • A simplistic, undeveloped argument is expressed through flawed or largely incoherent lines of reasoning that demonstrate use of an unfocused enquiry process. Uses limited accurate geographical terminology. (AO3) • Conclusions, if attempted, are simplistic; may attempt to support conclusions with limited links to evidence and concepts which are frequently irrelevant. (AO3)
Level 2	7–12	• Demonstrates geographical knowledge and understanding of location, geographical theory and comparative context, which are occasionally relevant and accurate. (AO1) • Applies understanding to find links between the investigation's conclusions and a broader geographical context with limited coherence. (AO2). • Synthesis of research findings is limited, but makes some coherent points. (AO3) • Appraisal of the reliability of evidence and validity of conclusions is imbalanced and includes some minor flaws. (AO3) • A simplistic argument is expressed through lines of reasoning, with some coherence that demonstrate use of an inconsistently structured enquiry process. Uses some accurate geographical terminology. (AO3) • Conclusions are simplistic, but occasionally supported with some relevant links to evidence and concepts. (AO3)

		Conclusions and Critical Evaluation of the Overall Investigation (24 marks) (AO1: 4 marks, AO2: 4 marks and AO3: 16 marks)
Level	Mark	Descriptor
Level 3	13–18	• Demonstrates mostly accurate and relevant geographical knowledge and understanding of location, geographical theory and comparative context. (AO1) • Applies understanding to find largely coherent and relevant links between the investigation's conclusions and a broader geographical context. (AO2) • Synthesises most aspects of the research findings in a largely coherent manner. (AO3) • Provides a mainly appropriate appraisal of the reliability of evidence and validity of conclusions. (AO3) • A developed argument which considers a relevant selection of factors in an uneven manner and which is expressed through logical lines of reasoning that are clear, but not fully developed and demonstrates a use of an appropriately structured enquiry process. Uses mostly accurate geographical terminology.(AO3) • Conclusions are mostly supported by drawing together a selection of mostly relevant evidence and concepts linked to the investigation. (AO3)
Level 4	19–24	• Demonstrates accurate and relevant geographical knowledge and understanding of location, geographical theory and comparative context throughout. (AO1) • Applies understanding to find coherent and relevant links between the investigation's conclusions and a broader geographical context. (AO2) • Synthesises research findings coherently and comprehensively. (AO3) • Provides a balanced appraisal of the reliability of evidence and validity of conclusions. (AO3) • A balanced and concise, well-developed argument is expressed through sustained logical lines of reasoning that demonstrates use of a structured and comprehensive enquiry process. Uses accurate geographical terminology throughout. (AO3) • Convincing conclusions that are fully supported by drawing together a selection of relevant evidence and concepts linked to the entire purpose of the investigation. (AO3)

Geography Independent Investigation form

All sections of the form in *Appendix 5* must be completed by candidate and teacher and the form must be attached to the work submitted for moderation. The forms may also be subject to inspection by a JCQ Centre Inspector. (Some JCQ inspections are targeted at centres with statistically atypical results in internal assessments.) Any suspected instances of malpractice will be reported to the Awarding Organisation for further investigation. If malpractice is found to have taken place a penalty will be given dependent on the circumstances and severity of the malpractice.

For full information regarding malpractice please see the JCQ document 'Suspected Malpractice in Examinations and Assessments'.

1. Candidate/teacher authentication section

Centres must ensure that the candidate authentication section is completed for each candidate by both the candidate and teacher. The form requires the following details (as per section 4.6 of the JCQ Instructions).

Candidates must sign a declaration to confirm that, apart from collaboration with other candidates and general guidance from the teacher, where these are acceptable within the parameters of the specification, the work which they submit for final assessment is their own unaided work.

Teachers must sign a declaration of authentication after the work has been completed confirming that:

- o any assistance which goes beyond general guidance has been recorded and taken into account when marking the work;
- o otherwise, apart from general guidance given in line with the parameters set out in the specification, the work is solely that of the candidate concerned;
- o the work was completed under the required conditions;
- o signed candidate declarations are kept on file.

Teachers should be sufficiently familiar with the candidate's general standard to judge whether the piece of work submitted is within his/her capabilities, and there should be sufficient supervision of every candidate to enable the work to be authenticated with confidence. Work may be completed outside of the centre, without supervision, provided that the centre is confident that the work produced is the candidate's own.

The forms, containing the signed candidate declarations, must be kept on file until the deadline for an enquiry about results has passed or until any appeal, malpractice or other results enquiry has been completed, whichever is later.

2. Investigation proposal section

Candidates use this section to detail their title, hypotheses and/or questions and/or sub-questions, enquiry route, suggested methods of data collection and suggestions of analytical tools.

Missing or incomplete Independent Investigation Forms

The remainder of this document should be read in conjunction with section 9 of the JCQ Instructions for conducting non-examination assessment.

If a Geography Independent Investigation form is found to be missing or incomplete, the Awarding Organisation will in the first instance contact the centre to rectify the matter. If this request is not addressed satisfactorily, the Awarding Organisation will take further action, which may lead to a malpractice investigation.

Mark sheet

Teachers complete this form when they mark the work, providing a mark breakdown and any supporting information in accordance with the Awarding Organisation's normal procedures.

Detecting malpractice

Malpractice may be suspected by teachers in work as follows:

- the style of writing is not typical of the candidate; it might be from published material, or from another person
- there are instances of the same errors in the work of two or more candidates
- there are passages quoted from publications or the internet which are not acknowledged in the bibliography or by in-text referencing
- there are passages copied from examples of good practice which were distributed to the whole class
- the work of one candidate is copied from another.

Dealing with malpractice

By centres:

- If the centre/teacher suspects some form of malpractice, the centre must take action to investigate internally. The centre should have in place procedures to deal with these issues across qualifications.
- The candidate and teacher should only complete the authentication section of the Geography Independent Investigation form once it is clear which parts of the work are the candidate's own. If the matter is not resolved the candidate should be awarded zero.

Consequences of malpractice

If malpractice is suspected the Awarding Organisation will investigate. If malpractice is found to have taken place a penalty will be given dependent on the circumstances and severity of the malpractice.

For full information regarding malpractice please see the JCQ document 'Suspected Malpractice in Examinations and Assessments'.

Security and backups

It is the centre's responsibility to keep the work that students have submitted for assessment secure.

Secure storage is defined as a securely-locked cabinet or cupboard. Where students are producing artefacts, secure storage is defined as a classroom studio or workshop that is locked or supervised from the end of one session to the start of the next.

The rules on storage also apply to electronic data. For example, centres should collect memory sticks for secure storage between sessions or restrict student access to specific areas of the centre's IT network.

For materials stored electronically, centres are strongly advised to utilise firewall protection and virus-checking software, and to employ an effective backup strategy, so that an up-to-date archive of students' evidence is maintained.

Further information

For up-to-date advice on teacher involvement and administration of non-examination assessment, please refer to the Joint Council for Qualifications (JCQ) document *GCE, ELC and Project qualifications – Instructions for Conducting Non-examined Assessments*, available on the JCQ website: www.jcq.org.uk